PROactive PRONUNCIATION

English Spelling Secrets

Each letter in English can be pronounced in various ways…let's take a look!

A

a	"AA" as in "cat"	/æ/	map
a	"AH" as in "cop"	/ɑ/	father
a	"UH" as in "about"	/ə/	another
a	"EH EE" as in "day"	/eɪ/	say
a	"IH" as in "pit"	/ɪ/	pirate
ea	"EE" as in "he"	/i/	meat
ea	"EH" as in "red"	/ɛ/	head
ea	"AH" as in "cop"	/ɑ/	heart
ea	"EH EE" as in "day"	/eɪ/	bear
au	"AH" as in "raw"	/ɑ/	cause, daughter
au	"EH EE" as in "day"	/eɪ/	gauge
au	"AA" as in "rat"	/æ/	aunt
au	"OH" as in "go"	/oʊ/	chauffeur
ai	"EH" as in "red"	/ɛ/	said
ai	"AH EE" as in "buy"	/aɪ/	aisle
ai	"EH EE" as in "say"	/eɪ/	maid
ai	"AA" as in "cat"	/æ/	plaid
ay	"EH" as in "red"	/ɛ/	said
ay	"EHEE" as in "day"	/eɪ/	say
ay	"EE" as in "me"	/i/	quay
eau	"YOO" as in "few"	/ju/	beautiful
eau	"OH" as in "go"	/oʊ/	beau
aw	"AH" as in "cop"	/ɑ/	bawl, shawl
ear	"ER" as in "her"	/ɜr/	pearl
oa	"OH" as in "go"	/oʊ/	oatmeal

B

silent			dumb
b	"b" as in "bit"	/b/	bat

C

c	"k" as in "car"	/k/	cake
c	"ch" as in "chip"	/ʧ/	cellist
ck	"k" as in "car"	/k/	sick
ch	"k" as in "car"	/k/	choir
ch	"ch" as in "chip"	/ʧ/	chop
ch	"sh" as in "shoe"	/ʃ/	parachute
chs	"sh" as in "shoe"	/ʃ/	fuchsia
tch	"ch" as in "chip"	/ʧ/	itch
ci	"ch" as in "chip"	/ʧ/	provincial
ci	"sh" as in "shoe"	/ʃ/	proficient
ce	"s" as in "so"	/s/	mice
ce	"sh" as in "shoe"	/ʃ/	ocean
cc	"ks" as in "x"	/ks/	accent
cz	"z" as in "time"	/z/	czar
sc	"s" as in "so"	/s/	scientific

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sch	“sh” as in “shoe”	/ʃ/	schnitzel
sci	“sh” as in “shoe”	/ʃ/	conscientious

D

d	“d” as in “do”	/d/	drag
d	“j” as in “jog”	/ʤ/	drawer
dge	“j” as in “jog”	/ʤ/	edge
dj	“j” as in “jog”	/ʤ/	adjective
ed	“t” as in “to”	/d/	locked

E

e	silent		here
e	“EH” as in “red”	/ɛ/	bed
e	“EE” as in “me”	/i/	he
e	“UH” as in “ ago”	/ə/	modem
e	“IH” as in “pit”	/ɪ/	pretty
e	“EH EE” as in “day”	/eɪ/	resume
ea	”AH” as in “mom”	/ɑ/	heartless
ea	“EE” as in “me”	/i/	tea
ea	“EH” as in “red”	/ɛ/	sweat
ea	“EH EE” as in “day”	/eɪ/	great
ee	“IH” as in “pit”	/ɪ/	been
ee	“EE” as in “me”	/i/	sweep
ee	“EH EE” as in “day”	/eɪ/	entree
oe	“OH” as in “go”	/oʊ/	doe
oe	“EE” as in “me”	/i/	phoenix
oe	“UH” as in “ago”	/ʌ/	does
oe	“OO” as in “two”	/u/	canoe
ie	“EH” as in “red”	/ɛ/	friend
ie	“EE” as in “me”	/i/	thief
ie	“AH EE” as in “hi”	/aɪ/	client
ei	“EE” as in “me”	/i/	receipt
ei	“EH EE” as in “day”	/eɪ/	vein, heir
eo	“EH” as in “red”	/ɛ/	leopard
eo	“EE” as in “me”	/i/	people
eu	“YOO” as in “you”	/ju/	reuse, feud
eu	“OO” as in “two”	/u/	deuce, sleuth
ew	“YOO” as in “you”	/ju/	few
ew	“OO” as in “two”	/u/	knew
ey	“EE” as in “me”	/i/	key
ey	“EH EE” as in “day”	/eɪ/	whey
eig	“UH” as in “ago”	/ə/	foreign
eigh	“EH EE” as in “day”	/eɪ/	eight
eigh	“AH EE” as in “hi”	/aɪ/	height
ear	“ER” as in “her”	/ɜr/	earn
er	“AH” as in “mom”	/ɑr/	sergeant
ue	“OO” as in “two”	/u/	Tuesday
ye	“AH EE” as in “hi”	/aɪ/	eye, dye

F

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f	“f” as in “fan”	/f/	off
f	“v” as in “van”	/v/	of

G

g	“g” as in “no”	/g/	go
g	“j” as in “jog”	/ʤ/	gin
gg	“j” as in “jog”	/ʤ/	exaggerated
dge	“j” as in “jug”	/ʤ/	edge
eigh	“EH EE” as in “day”	/eɪ/	weight
eigh	“AH EE” as in “my”	/aɪ/	height
igh	…“AH EE” as in “my”	/aɪ/	sigh
ge	“zh” as in “beige”	/ʒ/	measurement
ng	“ng” as in “ring”	/ŋ/	wing
ng	“nG” as in “jungle”	/ŋg/	anger
ough	“OH” as in “go”	/oʊ/	although
ough	“AH” as in “cop”	/a/	slough, cough
ough	“OO” as in “two”	/u/	throughout
ough	“AA OO” as in “how”	/aʊ/	bough, plough
ough	“UH” as in “up”	/ʌ/	tough, rough, hiccough

H

silent			hour, thyme, honourable
h	“h” as in “he”	/h/	have
th	“th” as in “think”	/θ/	thought
th	“th” as in “the”	/ð/	this
sch	“sh” as in “she”	/ʃ/	schnitzel
sh	“sh” as in “she”	/ʃ/	ship
ch	“k” as in “cup”	/k/	chorus
ch	“ch” as in “chair”	/ʧ/	chop
ch	“sh” as in “shop”	/ʃ/	Champaign
chs	“sh” as in “shop”	/ʃ/	fuchsia
eigh	“EH EE” as in “day	/eɪ/	weight
eigh	“AH EE” as in “my”	/aɪ/	height
ough	“OH” as in “go”	/oʊ/	although
ough	“OO” as in “two”	/u/	throughout
ough	“AA OO” as in “how”	/aʊ/	bough
ough	“AH” as in “cop”	/ɑ/	cough
ough	“UH” as in “up”	/ʌ/	tough, enough
ph	“f” as in “four”	/f/	phonics, phone
pph	“f” as in “four”	/f/	sapphire
tch	“ch” as in “chip”	/ʧ/	catch

I

i	“IH” as in “sit”	/ɪ/	his
i	“AH EE” as in “my”	/aɪ/	fine
i	“EE” as in “me”	/i/	sushi
i	“UH” as in “ago”	/ə/	unicorn
ai	“EH” as in “red”	/ɛ/	said
ai	“AH EE” as in “my”	/aɪ/	Kaiser, aisle
ai	“EH EE” as in “day	/eɪ/	pain

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ai	“AA” as in “cat”	/æ/	plaid
ei	“EE” as in “me”	/i/	receipt
ei	“EH EE” as in “day	/eɪ/	vein
eig	“IH” as in “it”	/ɪ/	foreign
eig	“EH EE” as in “day	/eɪ/	feign
eigh	“EH EE” as in “day	/eɪ/	eight
eigh	“AH EE” as in “my”	/aɪ/	height
ie	“EH” as in “red”	/ɛ/	friend
ie	“EE” as in “me”	/i/	fiend
ie	“AH EE” as in “my”	/aɪ/	pliers
ieu	“OO” as in “two”	/u/	lieutenant
igh	“AH EE” as in “my”	/aɪ/	might
ci	“ch” as in “chair”	/ʧ/	provincial
ci	“sh” as in “she”	/ʃ/	commercial
ui	“IH” as in “sit”	/ɪ/	guilt
ui	“OO” as in “two”	/u/	suit
ir	“ER” as in “her”	/ɜr/	bird
oi	“OH EE” as in “boy”	/ɔɪ/	coin
sci	“sh” as in “she”	/ʃ/	conscious
si	“zh” as in “beige”	/ʒ/	television
ti	“sh” as in “she”	/ʃ/	lotion
ti	“ch” as in “chip”	/ʧ/	mansion

J

j	“j” as in “jog”	/ʤ/	Jacket
j	“y” as in “you”	/j/	fjord
dj	“j” as in “jog”	/ʤ/	judge

K

silent			knowledge, knife
k	“k” as in “cup”	/k/	kill
ck	“k” as in “cup”	/k/	lock

L

silent			palm, talk, chalk, walk, calm
l	“l” as in “lip”	/l/	lost
ll	“l” as in “lip”	/l/	selling

M

m	“m” as in “mop”	/m/	move
mm	“m” as in “mop”	/m/	hammer

N

silent			column, womb, comb, lamb
n	“n” as in “no”	/n/	now
n	“ng” as in “so”	/ŋ/	plank
nn	“n” as in “no”	/n/	bunny
ng	“ng” as in “song”	/ŋ/	king
ng	“ng” as in “jungle”	/ŋg/	stronger

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O

o	“w” as in “wel”	/w/	once
o	“IH” as in “sit”	/ɪ/	women
o	“AH” as in “cop”	/ɑ/	not
o	“OO” as in “two”	/u/	to
o	“OUH” as in “book”	/ʊ/	woman
o	“OH” as in “go”	/oʊ/	no
o	“UH” as in “up”	/ʌ/	dove, love
o	“UH” as in “ago”	/ə/	bottom
oo	“OO” as in “two”	/u/	school
oo	“OUH” as in “book”	/ʊ/	look
oo	“UH” as in “up”	/ʌ/	flood
oo	“OH” as in “go”	/oʊ/	tandoori, brooch
oe	“OH” as in “go”	/oʊ/	doe
oe	“UH” as in “up”	/ʌ/	does
oe	“OO” as in “two”	/u/	canoe, shoe
oe…	“EE” as in “me”	/i/	phoenix, theory
eo	“EH” as in “red”	/ɛ/	leopard
eo	“EE” as in “me”	/i/	people
oa	“OH” as in “go”	/oʊ/	goal
oi	“oy” as in “toy”	/ɔɪ/	boy
ou	“OO” as in “two”	/u/	tour, ghoul, you
ou	“UH” as in “ago”	/ə/	pompous, jealous
ou	“OUH” as in “book”	/ʊ/	could, would, should
ou	“UH” as in “up”	/ʌ/	double
ou	“OH” as in “go”	/oʊ/	mould
ou	“AA OO” as in “how”	/aʊ/	found
ough	“OH” as in “go”	/oʊ/	although, thorough
ough	“OO” as in “two”	/u/	through
ough	“AA OO” as in “how”	/aʊ/	plough, bough
ough	“AH” as in “cop”	/ɑ/	bought, cough
ough	“UH” as in “up”	/ʌ/	tough
our	“er” as in “her”	/ɜr/	tournament
or	“er” as in “her”	/ɜr/	rumor, juror, word
ow	“AA OO” as in “how”	/aʊ/	now
ow	“OH” as in “go”	/oʊ/	low
oy	“OY” as in “boy”	/ɔɪ/	toy
wo	“OO” as in “two”	/u/	womb, two

P

silent			psychological, pneumonia
p	“p” as in “pot”	/p/	people
ph	“f” as in “for”	/f/	photo, aphid, phone
pph	“f” as in “for”	/f/	sapphires

Q

q	“k” as in “cup”	/k/	queen

R

r	“r” as in “red”	/r/	right

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S

silent			aisle, island
chs	“sh” as in “shoe”	/ʃ/	fuchsia
s	“s” as in “sit”	/s/	so
s	“z” as in “zit”	/z/	is
s	“sh” as in “shoe”	/ʃ/	sure, sugar
s	“zh” as in “beige”	/ʒ/	treasure, measuring
sc	“s” as in “sit”	/s/	scientific
sch	“sh” as in “shoe”	/ʃ/	schnapps, schmuck
sci	“sh” as in “shoe”	/ʃ/	luscious, conscience
si	“zh” as in “beige”	/ʒ/	television
sh	“sh” as in “shoe”	/ʃ/	show
ss	“sh” as in “shoe”	/ʃ/	tissue
ss	“s” as in “sit”	/s/	issues
ss	“z” as in “zit”	/z/	possessive

T

silent			listen
t	“t” as in “to”	/t/	try
t	“ch” as in “chip”	/ʧ/	torture
th	“th” as in “think”	/θ/	throw
th	“th” as in “the”	ð/	these
tch	“ch” as in “chip”	/ʧ/	witch
ti	“sh” as in “shoe”	/ʃ/	lotion
ti	“ch” as in “chip”	/ʧ/	mention

U

u	“UH” as in “ago”	/ə/	autumn
u	“UH” as in “up”	/ʌ/	sun
u	“YOU” as in “few”	/ju/	university
u	“EH” as in “red”	/ɛ/	bury
u	“OUH” as in “book”	/ʊ/	put
u	“OO” as in “two”	/u/	absolute
u	“w” as in “we”	/w/	quit, suite
u	“IH” as in “sit”	/ɪ/	minute
au	“AH” as in “cop”	/a/	pause
au	“EH EE” as in “say”	/eɪ/	gauge
au	“AA” as in “cat”	/æ/	laugh, aunt
au	“OH” as in “go”	/oʊ/	brontosaur, chauffeur
ou	“UH” as in “up”	/ʌ/	double
ou	“OUH” as in “book”	/ʊ/	would
ou	“OO” as in “two”	/u/	wound, tour, you
ou	“OH” as in “go”	/oʊ/	pour
ou	“AA OO” as in “how”	/aʊ/	sound
ough	“OH” as in “go”	/oʊ/	dough
ough	“OO” as in “two”	/u/	through
ough	“AA OO” as in “how”	/aʊ/	bough
ough	“AH” as in “cop”	/a/	cough
ough	“UH” as in “up”	/ʌ/	enough

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eu	"YOU" as in "few"	/ju/	euchre, feud
eu	"OO" as in "two"	/u/	leucoplast, sleuth
eau	"YOU" as in "few"	/ju/	beautiful
eau	"OH" as in "go"	/oʊ/	plateau, bandeau, beau
ieu	"OO" as in "two"	/u/	lieutenant, lieu
our	"er" as in "bird"	/ɝ/	tournament
ue	"OO" as in "two"	/u/	true
ui	"IH" as in "sit"	/ɪ/	guild
ui	"OO" as in "two"	/u/	fruit, juice
ur	"er" as in "bird"	/ɝ/	turn
uy	"AH EE" as in "my"	/aɪ/	guy, buy

V

v	"v" as in "vote"	/v/	violin

W

silent			wrath, wrong, answer, write
w	"w" as in "we"	/w/	will
ow	"AA OO" as in "how"	/aʊ/	now
ow	"OH" as in "go"	/oʊ/	bow
ew	"YOU" as in "few"	/ju/	pew
ew	"OO" as in "two"	/u/	new
aw	"AH" as in "cop"	/a/	bawl
wo	"OO" as in "two"	/u/	two

X

x	"z" as in "zit"	/z/	xylophone
x	"ks" as in "cup"	/ks/	axe, exempt
x	"gz" as in "eggs"	/gz/	exist

Y

y	"y" as in "yes"	/j/	yellow
y	"EE" as in "me"	/i/	happy
y	"IH" as in "sit"	/ɪ/	rhythm
y	"UH" as in "ago"	/ə/	symmetrical, hysterical
y	"AH EE" as in "my"	/aɪ/	hydraulic, rhyme
ay	"EH" as in "red"	/ɛ/	says
ay	"EH EE" as in "day	/eɪ/	say
ey	"EE" as in "me"	/i/	donkey, key
ey	"EH EE" as in "day	/eɪ/	whey, they
oy	"OH EE" as in "boy"	/ɔɪ/	toy
uy	"AH EE" as in "my"	/aɪ/	guys, buy
ye	"AH EE" as in "my"	/aɪ/	eye, bye
yr	"er" as in "bird"	/ɝ/	syrup, myrrh

Z

z	"z" as in "zit"	/z/	crazy
z	"zh" as in "beige"	/ʒ/	seizure
z	"ts" as in "its"	/ts/	Nazi

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z	“s” as in “sit”	/s/	waltz, blitz
zz	“z” as in “zit”	/z/	buzzard
cz	“z” as in “zit”	/z/	czar